Linking interpersonal and intrapersonal emotion regulation in parent-adolescent dyads: Evidence from a daily diary study

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Introduction

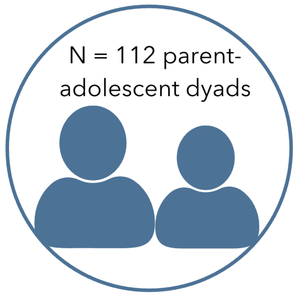
- Adolescence is a pivotal period for emotion regulation (ER) development and parents play a key role in shaping this process (Eisenberg et al., 1998; Morris et al., 2017; Silvers, 2022)
- Parents' own ER may influence adolescents' ER development indirectly (e.g., through modeling) or indirectly (e.g., through coaching) (Morris et al., 2007; 2017)

- **Intrapersonal ER:** Strategies used to independently regulate one's own emotions
- **Interpersonal ER:** Strategies used to regulate others' emotions (Do et al., 2025; Gadassi-Polack et al., 2024)

- Some previous evidence for parent-adolescent similarity in the use of intrapersonal reappraisal/suppression (Bariola et al., 2012; Silva et al., 2018)

Method

- 112 adolescents (M_{age} = 14.1; 55% female) and their parents participated in a daily diary study: Parent-Adolescent Interpersonal emotion Regulation Study (PAIRS; Gadassi Polack et al., 2025)



Reported on:

own current emotions
↓
intrapersonal strategies used
+
partner's peak emotions
↓
interpersonal strategies used

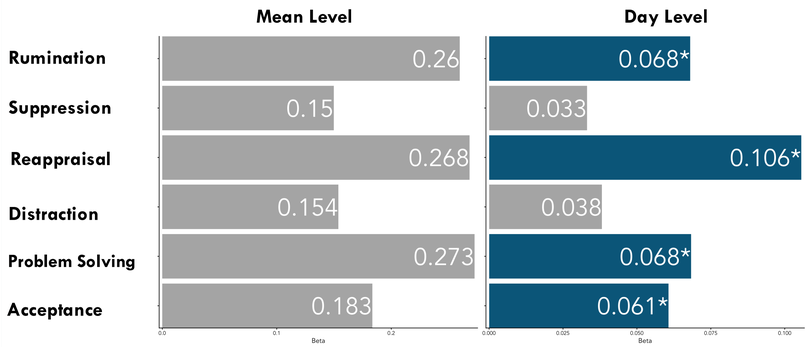
Strategies

- Reappraisal
- Suppression
- (Co)rumination
- Acceptance
- Distraction
- Problem Solving

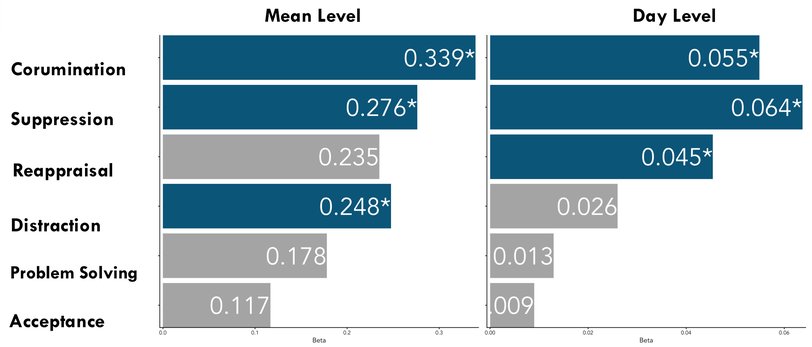
- We used linear regression and multilevel models to quantify same-strategy associations

Funding Information: Funding for this work was provided by the National Institute of Mental Health Translational Developmental Neuroscience Training Grant (T32 #MH18268), The Israeli Council for Higher Education Postdoctoral Research Fellowship for Women, and the Marie Sklodowska-Curie Individual Fellowship (786460) under the European Union's Horizon 2020 research and innovation program awarded to Reuma Gadassi Polack.

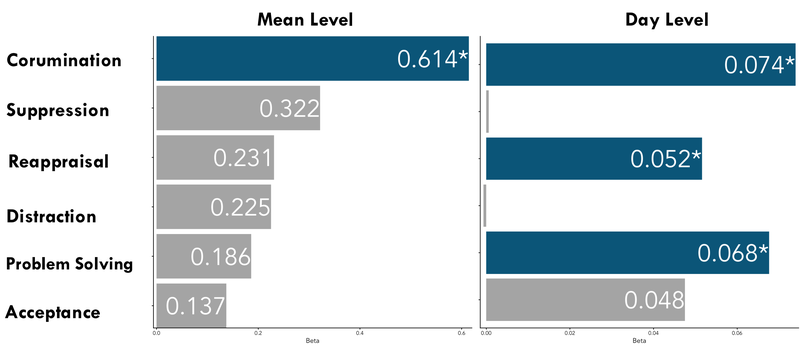
RQ1. Are parents' and adolescents' use of intrapersonal ER strategies associated at the individual strategy level?



RQ2. Are parents' and adolescents' use of interpersonal ER strategies associated at the individual strategy level?



***RQ3.* Are parents' use of interpersonal ER strategies associated with adolescents' use of the analogous intrapersonal strategies?**



All plots display mean-centered betas; blue highlight and asterisk indicates statistical significance at $p < .05$ after adjusting for multiple comparisons (Benjamini & Hochberg, 1995) within each research question's series of tests.

Results

RQ1.

In mean-level models, no significant associations emerged

In day-level models, significant within-dyad associations were found for reappraisal (β = 0.106), problem solving (β = 0.068), rumination (β = 0.068), and acceptance (β = 0.061

RQ2.

In mean-level models, significant associations were found for corumination (β = 0.339), suppression (β = 0.276), and distraction (β = 0.248)

In day-level models, significant associations were detected for suppression (β = 0.064), corumination (β = 0.055), and reappraisal (β = 0.045)

RQ3.

In mean-level models, significant associations were found only for corumination (β = 0.614)

In day-level models, significant associations were detected for corumination (β = 0.074), problem solving (β = 0.068), and reappraisal (β = 0.052)

Discussion

Strategies that may be more easily verbalized and involve active engagement with the emotion showed the most consistent parent-adolescent correspondence

Parents' use of **corumination was an especially salient predictor of adolescents' rumination**

Future studies may focus on positive emotions and measurement across development

References & Links

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